



March 28, 2023

Brecksville - Broadview Heights City School District
6638 Mill Road
Brecksville, Ohio 44141

Dear Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools Board of Education,

Thank you for considering Finding Leaders to conduct the search for your next superintendent for the Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools. Finding Leaders is ready to help you find the most qualified, best candidate for this leadership position.

Finding Leaders Profile:

Finding Leaders is a national network of experienced former and active superintendents, treasurers, educators, board of education members, human resource personnel, management and public engagement specialists who provide a personalized search for superintendents, treasurers, and other school administrators. With more than 150 years of combined experience, we work side-by-side with the board, while engaging staff, students, and residents to find the right candidate for your educational institution. We are situated near Cleveland, Ohio with eighteen consultants representing a diverse network of experienced professionals.

Not only will we help you find your next educational leader, but we will also support the Board and the new leader throughout the first year of employment. Included in our services is a one-year **transition plan** that includes a full-day board-leadership retreat as well as executive coaching throughout the year. Also, Finding Leaders has a **one-year guarantee**. If a suitable candidate is not identified, we will conduct the search again without charge. We also guarantee the success of the new superintendent for one full year after the search, or we will conduct the search again without charge. We also guarantee that we will not recruit your new leader for any other leadership positions for a period of five years.

It is evident that the Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools are equipping students to achieve success in a global society by implementing an effective and rigorous curriculum with fidelity.

The Key Steps in the Search Process for a new Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools Leader Include the Following Phases:

Engagement Phase: During this first step, using a SWOT analysis, Finding Leaders will conduct targeted focus groups and key leader briefings to assist the Board in identifying the qualities and characteristics of the new superintendent upon which a desired profile will be developed.

Search Phase: In this second phase, Finding Leaders will advertise the position to a broad pool of potential candidates throughout the state, region and nationally. There could be some overlap between the Engagement Phase and the Search Phase.

Interview and Selection Phase: Finding Leaders will personally vet (conduct initial due diligence activities including basic criminal background checks and employment records), screen and interview a group of interested and qualified candidates. Based on the adopted profile, we will recommend several (about six, if possible) candidates to the Board for initial, first round interviews while presenting the entire slate of applicants to the Board. Then using the Finding Leaders district specific interview rubric, we will ask the Board to narrow the field down to two finalists (sometimes three). Afterwards the Board will conduct due diligence activities and bring the two finalists back for the second-round process including stakeholder interviews, an informal Board dinner with each candidate and final Board interviews.

Selection Phase: After the Interview Phase, Finding Leaders will assist the Board in its deliberations to select a new educational leader. We will be present at all meetings to facilitate interviews, maintain communications with all candidates and assist the Board in negotiating the final contract, if requested.

Transition Phase: Finding Leaders will provide the Board and the new leader with a nine-month transition plan designed to assist the Board and the new leader in determining roles, responsibilities, communication, and decision-making processes. In addition, we will offer to conduct a free Board-Administrative retreat to “Get to Know You,” discuss current district issues and determine how best to work together effectively and efficiently as a team. We will also be available to provide a year-long mentorship with the new superintendent.

Finding Leaders was founded on the concept of “Community Engagement.” We believe that stakeholders should be engaged in providing input to the Board when selecting a new district leader. So, we use targeted focus groups with the Board of Education, staff, students, families, and the school district community early in the process to assist the Board in developing a leadership profile. We also conduct key leader briefings with suggested community leaders to secure their input. We suggest that a cross selection of stakeholders be involved in the final interview process providing input to the Board who must make the final employment decision. This facilitated stakeholder interview process will occur over a two-day period with representatives of the certified staff, support staff, administrators, students, community members and the Board of Education. These sessions will include a one-hour interview with stakeholders, a one-hour reflective

session, a dinner with the Board and then a final interview with each of the final candidates.

Advertising and Recruitment Steps: (According to a recent Jobvite survey, 50% of job searchers heard about job opening from friends, 37% from professional networks, and 35% from social media) Finding Leaders will advertise and recruit individuals for the position in the following locations:

- Buckeye Association of School Administrators (BASA)
- Ohio School Boards Association (OSBA) (\$200)
- American Association of School Administrators (AASA) (Additional Fee)
- Finding Leaders web site-www.findingleaders.com
- Ohio Schools Council (OSC)
- Education Week (for a national search)(Additional Fee)
- Other state associations on-line posting
- Ohio School Business Officials Association (OASBO)(For Treasurer searches)
- K12jobspots.com
- If desired, we will use embedded social media job searching tools (LinkedIn)
- Additional posting sites may be utilized upon request
- Personal networks and connections

Responsibilities of Finding Leaders and the Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools Board of Education:

Finding Leaders agree to provide the following consulting services to the Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools Board of Education in connection with the Board's effort to fill the leadership vacancy:

- Advisory and general consultation
- Conduct a compensation package survey of similar districts and assist the Board in determining the appropriate salary and benefits for the new leader
- Maintain communications with the Board and the candidates throughout the process
- Conduct local focus groups and key leader interviews to help determine the profile/qualifications and characteristics of the new leader.
- Distribute a promotional brochure that describes the vacancy and solicits applications
- Prepares application and reference forms
- Receive, process, maintain and dispose of applications, reference, forms, and supplemental materials
- Recruit from among viable sources candidates that fit the locally developed profile
- Conduct the initial screening and vetting of candidates by checking references both listed by the candidate and through our network of educational leaders
- Prepares a report for the Board of all candidates and the suggested semi-final candidates.

- Assist in structuring Board, staff and/or community interviews of the final candidates
- Schedule interviews with final candidates
- Notifies applicants not selected for the position.
- Provide an outline of a free written nine-month transition plan which includes three Board-Superintendent retreats, creation of a support team, BOE cottage meetings, weekly transition bulletin for staff, creation of a key communicators group, and a 360-degree feedback survey.
- Negotiate the final contract with the chosen candidate, if requested
- Finding Leaders will facilitate, coordinate, and assist the Board through every step of the process including bi-weekly updates.

Services requested by Finding Leaders of the Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools Board of Education and the district staff include:

- The Board retains the final right and responsibility for selection of its next superintendent,
- Establish the salary, benefits, and other terms to be included in the superintendent's contract of employment with its selected leader,
- Set the parameters of the search process upon the advice and recommendations of the Finding Leaders consultants.
- Establish and set up the desired district focus groups
- Determine the following:
 - Potential Internal candidates
 - "Favorite Son" candidates
 - The strengths, concerns, and immediate problems of the Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools District
 - The administrative experience preferred
 - The advanced academic degree required
 - The residency requirement of the new leader
 - The search timelines based on Finding Leaders recommendations
 - Components and terms of the contract of the new leader

It is the policy of Finding Leaders to recruit, interview and consider a diverse pool of applicants without any discrimination due to disability, race, sex, religious, national origin, or handicap situation. Through our continued mentoring, the implementation of the transition plan for the new superintendent and our ability to remain objective during the search process assures equal opportunity to all applicants.

Prior to Finding Leaders interviews we will personally vet all applicants by doing a social media scan, contacting previous and current employers, connecting with acquaintances in nearby school districts or ESCs, discussing applicants with officials at BASA and other appropriate organizations and conduct a local newspaper scan. Then we will ask the Board to conduct their own due diligence activities (suggested guideline

will be provided) including checking more than one place of employment, conducting a newspaper scan, speaking with at least one present and a previous board of education member, visiting the applicant in his/her place of employment, taking them out for lunch and conducting a professional social media scan.

We will use “**Finding Leaders Fit**” to help assure the best candidate match with the Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools City Schools superintendent profile. “Fit” is composed of several components listed below:

- Using our on-line application process, Frontline Education/Applitrack, candidates answer designed questions addressing the specific Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools profile.
- For the two finalists, we offer the **Harrison Talent Assessment**, a tool designed to match a specific job profile with a candidate's ability to perform all aspects of a school's leadership job requirements.
- We use a Finding Leaders designed **interview rubric** specific to Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools to assess a candidate's match/fit with the district's profile and the Ohio superintendent standards.

In return for the services to be rendered by the Consultants under this agreement, the Board agrees to pay the Consultants the sum of **\$15,500** for the search as the consultant fee plus necessary expenses in full as follows:

\$7,750.00 upon the signing of this contract and

\$7,750.00 plus expenses upon delivery of the list of final candidates

Expenses not included in the basic consultant fee are:

- a. the cost of advertising (about \$200-5000)
- b. reimbursement of travel expenses for consultants and candidates (about \$300)
- c. the cost of printing (about \$300)

Thank you, once again, for considering Finding Leaders to conduct your upcoming leadership search. Finding a new educational leader who shares your district's vision and mission will be our top priority. Feel free to visit www.findingleaders.com to learn more about our team and services or contact us with pertinent questions. We are not involved in any other searches that might conflict with our full attention being focused on the Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools. We do not have any unresolved finding for recovery issued by the Auditor of State. No consultant of Finding Leaders has any direct or indirect personal interest in the Brecksville - Broadview Heights City Schools that may create a potential violation of Ohio's Ethics Laws for any Board of Education member or District personnel. Since Finding Leaders has no employees, only contracted consultants, we are not involved in the worker's compensation system.

Sincerely,

Paul Pendleton
Finding Leaders
Founder/Owner
pendlent@aol.com 216-225-2787

FINDING LEADERS

DATE: _____

BRECKSVILLE - BROADVIEW HEIGHTS CITY SCHOOLS

DATE: _____